

Orphans to Rent— A Children's Christmas Story

It was Christmas eve at the Bayville Home For Orphans, and three little boys sat in the chilly dining room looking out at the flying flakes of snow. It was after supper, and there was a clatter of dishes in the kitchen.

"They say," said Jimmy, "there's going to be a big Christmas tree in the parlor tomorrow."

"With candy and presents and everything, but I'd rather hang up my stockings than have all the old Christmas trees. You betcha I would!"

"So would I," echoed Bobby and George.

"That trustee who was here today would make a dandy man for a father or an uncle," said Bobby.

"He's awful rich."

"And he ain't got any children or any folks at all."

"I wish he'd 'dopt me,'" reflected George.

"He patted my head."

"He must be lonesome without any folks," began Bobby. Then he leaned over and whispered to his companions.

Fifteen minutes later three little boys, the oldest ten and the youngest six, let themselves out through a basement door and hurried across the snowy yard to the opening in the hedge which led through a patch of woods to the village.

Mr. Bartley, the trustee, who often visited the home, lived in a big house with a wonderful garden. Everything was blanketed in snow now, and the big house was dark save for a few lighted windows on the lower floor.

Soon they stood on the porch peering in at a cozy library, where Mr. Bartley sat in a big chair before the fire, looking very lonesome. A big dog, a collie, sat beside him with his head on his master's knee.

Suddenly the dog lifted his head and barked. Mr. Bartley looked toward the window and saw the three little frightened boys peering in.

In a jiffy he had jumped up, opened the window and lifted them in one at a time.

"Good gracious me! What are you doing out there?" he demanded.

"Please, sir, we're from the home," said Bobby. "We knew you lived all alone—and we thought maybe you'd like to hire us three kids to spend Christmas with you. We don't want any tree," explained Bobby. "We just want to hang up our stockings and wake up—something like home—before we came to the 'sylum.'"

Mr. Bartley flourished a handkerchief and tried to laugh, but his voice cracked so queerly.

"Now, that's a funny thing," he declared. "I was just wishing I had three nice boys to spend Christmas with me—and maybe live with me all the time."

By and by Mr. Bartley called a manservant, and together they took the three little boys up to bed.

Then they hung their stockings on the corners of the big four post bedstead, and in two minutes they were sound asleep, while the servant, Martin, nodded in a chair outside in the hall and Mr. Bartley, buttoned into a fur lined overcoat, went striding down the snowy street to the brightly lighted shops.

I don't know who was the happier that Christmas morning, the three little boys with stockings full of treasures or big Mr. Bartley, whom they called "Uncle Dick." And the best of it all was that Mr. Bartley adopted all three of the little lads who came to him that Christmas eve, and they are growing up into such fine, big boys.

Albany, Ore.—Personal commendation from Herbert Hoover himself of a plan he proposed for the utilization of small potatoes was received last week by D. C. McClure of Albany in a letter from the United States food administrator. Mr. McClure experimented with scrubbing them clean and then dropping them in boiling fat. He made public his plan in the local press. "It's a very good scheme and is well worth passing on," wrote Mr. Hoover.

Obituaries

Mrs. Ella Reed
Mrs. Ella Reed, wife of Charles Reed of Oregon City, well known here, died Friday at a Portland hospital following an operation. Mrs. Reed was afflicted with blindness in connection with her other ailments, and was hastened to the hospital. A daughter was born at the hospital on Thursday and has been taken into the home of Mrs. Esther Kruger, Mrs. Reed's sister, at Portland. Mrs. Reed was 21 years old and was born in Dayton, Or. She had been married to Mr. Reed about a year. Funeral services were held from the Holman chapel Saturday afternoon and interment was in the Mountain View cemetery. Rev. E. E. Gilbert of the Methodist Episcopal church, presided. Those who survive Mrs. Reed are the husband, her parents, Mr. and Mrs. J. W. Turner of this city, three sisters and five brothers.

Pallbearers at the funeral were Mrs. Francis Eckerson, Misses Evelyn and Catherine Robinson, Misses Mary Gerber, Hazel Montgomery and Lena Costley. Mrs. W. C. Green and Miss Naomi Armstrong sang "Rock of Ages" and "Lead Kindly Light." Floral tributes were beautiful and in profusion.

A Christmas Burglar

AHA! A burglar in the room! I hear his stealthy tread; He's skulking somewhere through the gloom.

By yonder trundle bed, Across the creaking chamber floor His fearful footsteps fall.

What form was that stole through the door And out along the hall?

What form was that, clad all in white And scarcely three feet high?

A burglar! Or some Christmas sprite With mischief in his eye?

What! You! Abroad before the day Has lit his round, red lamp?

What takes you from your slumbers, pray, You little, outish scamp?

You came away down here because You really felt that you Must wait for Mr. Santa Claus

And see if he was true? You braved the darkness, unafraid And all its terrors grim,

And this long, dreadful journey made To prove your faith in him!

Well, back to bed, for he is true; Your precious faith hold fast. Old Santa Claus will live for you

While dreams and childhood last. And when at length you take your place Among the world of men,

In every little Christmas face He'll live for you again.

—James J. Montague in New York American.



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SOUTHERN PACIFIC LINES

ANOTHER SCRAP OF PAPER AND TIMELY SUPPOSITION

Suppose several years ago we had borrowed \$10,000 from you, giving our note. Suppose the note had become due in 1914. You tried to collect but we refused to pay, simply saying our note was a "mere scrap of paper!" That was in 1914. Suppose we should try to borrow another \$10,000 from you now, giving our note. Would you loan us the money on that basis?

Several years ago the German government signed a treaty guaranteeing the neutrality of Belgium in case of war. In 1914 the German government violated that treaty, publicly declaring it a "mere scrap of paper." Now that government wants to make a treaty of peace. What guarantee has the world that such a treaty would be respected?

Either the German people themselves must get control of their irresponsible government or the armies of that government must be decisively beaten on the battlefield. The German people can take their choice. Peace with the Hohenzollern pirates would be merely an armed truce. Better a fight to a finish now than another slaughter-fest later.

—C. A. King Co. Market Report.

Don't Say These Old Things at Christmas

DEAR ME! It's a lucky thing Christmas comes only once a year. I don't know what we'd do if it came oftener.

It isn't so much the value of a present as the spirit in which it is given.

I hang my stocking up just to please the children. I dread telling them there's no Santa Claus. Let some one else do that.

It never seems like Christmas to me unless it snows.

I always try to give sensible gifts—something useful, that will be a reminder all the year.

Money is always such an acceptable present. There isn't one of us who has so much that he can't take a little more.

Don't you pity the poor at this time of the year? I do.

Christmas and New Year's come so close together. It's too bad they could not be separated a little. Two holidays coming right on top of each other that way make it so hard, but then the children enjoy it.

I never know what to give father. It's so hard to think of anything for a man. And my rich friends—they have everything already.—Puck.

Christmas Chimes.
Ring out, ring out, oh Christmas bells, Across the starlit, frosty night! Proclaim the message of good will, The story of the Prince of Light.

The centuries roll on and on, And yet, returning Christmas time Awakes in each responsive heart Remembrance of the love sublime.

Then keep the feast with hearty cheer, The feast of merry Christmaside, While faith and hope and love, these three, Within the heart of each abide.

—W. G. Park in Good Housekeeping.

CLACKAMAS COUNTY'S GRADING BID LOWEST

Clackamas county was a successful bidder Monday for grading of a four and one-half mile section of the Pacific highway between Oregon City and Canemah, according to figures given out by the state highway department.

The bid of the county was \$34,765, which is approximately the same as the estimate of the state highway department.

Other bids opened by the state highway commission for the work were as follows: Warren Construction company, \$48,577; Oregon Haslam Paving company, \$49,463; United Contracting company, \$49,732. To the cost of the grading Clackamas county is to contribute \$25,000. The state will appropriate \$10,000.

BIRD IS INSANE

Scotts Mills Boy Sent to Salem for Vicious Actions

Earl Bird, 24 years old, son of a prominent Scotts Mills farmer, and whose mother is an inmate of the state hospital, was committed to the asylum on Saturday on complaint of J. W. Paquette. Bird is said to have developed vicious and destructive tendencies and showed signs of violence when he was arrested. He thinks he is being very generally imposed upon and refused Saturday to lend any aid in the examination that was made of him. The boy, who is a native of this county, was arrested by Deputy Sheriff Lou Hubbard, who was notified that he was acting peculiarly while visiting at Silverton on Friday.

SALARIES INCREASED

Two Members of High School Staff to Get More Pay

Salary increases of \$5 a month in each case were granted by the city school board Thursday night to W. L. Arant, high school principal, and Burr E. Tatrow, head of the commercial department, whose names were not on the list of those who received increases several weeks ago. The board also decided to commence the Christmas holiday season for all school children on Friday, December 22, and resume class work on Wednesday, January 2. This will give the school children 10 full days of vacation.

TWO YOUTHS FAIL

Physical Defects Cause Downfall of Prominent County Boys

Two more Clackamas county boys have been sent back from Camp Lewis, American Lake, because of physical unfitness for army duty. They are Russell C. Scramlin, of Macksburg, and Robert Rosenau, of Sunnyside. The local exemption board will probably have to certify one man in order to fill the vacancy caused by the failure of these two, as only one man is now certified. He is George Bertrand Smith, now of Portland, but formerly of Molalla.

The Courier and The Oregon Farmer—both for \$1.00.

Tractors

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FROMONG, STRIKER, IS BOUND TO GRAND JURY

The case of Andrew Fromong, of Willamette, hailed into justice court last Thursday on a charge of assault and battery said to have been committed upon the person of Mahlon Snidow, was heard by Justice of the Peace John N. Sievers

and Fromong was bound over to the grand jury upon motion of District Attorney Gilbert L. Hedges. Fromong is at liberty under \$100 bonds, furnished by B. T. McBain, local manager of the Crown-Willamette mills, and M. D. Phillips. Fromong is a strikebreaker employed at the Crown-Willamette plant and Snidow, whom he is said to have assaulted, is a member of a striking union.

Albany, Ore.—Because the voters of the Scio school district have refused to vote a special levy to pay off the indebtedness of the district the entire school board has resigned. The resignations of F. T. Thayer, Dr. A. G. Prill and J. L. Calavan, directors, and J. F. Wesley, Clerk, were received by County School Superintendent Cummings.



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